

Account Management Knowledge Base

Customer Support Knowledge Base

1. Account Creation and Requirements

Customers can create a Contoso Devices account to manage orders, devices, support requests, and communication preferences. Account registration should use an active email address that the customer can access.

To create an account, open the Contoso Devices account registration page, enter the requested profile information, create a strong password, and complete any verification step presented during registration. Customers should use accurate information so support agents can identify the account when assistance is required.

Passwords should be unique and difficult to guess. Customers should not reuse a Contoso Devices password on another service. Support representatives will never ask customers to disclose their complete password.

Customer question: Can I create an account if I only want product support? **Answer:** Yes. An account can make it easier to manage support interactions, but customers should follow the support process provided for their specific issue.

2. Signing In and Password Recovery

Customers who cannot remember their password should use the password-reset process rather than repeatedly guessing credentials. A reset message is sent using the account's registered contact information when the request can be verified.

If a password-reset message does not arrive, customers should check the correct email account, review spam or filtered folders, wait briefly, and request another reset message. Repeated requests may result in several messages; customers should use the most recent valid reset instruction.

Customer question: I forgot my password and cannot sign in. What should I do? **Answer:** Start the password-reset process, follow the verification instructions, and create a new unique password. If account recovery still fails, contact customer support for assistance.

Customers should not send passwords, one-time verification codes, or private security information through ordinary support messages.

3. Email, Phone, and Profile Changes

Customers may need to update their email address, phone number, display name, or communication preferences after creating an account. Changes should be made through the authenticated account-management process.

If a customer no longer has access to the registered email address, additional verification may be required before the contact information can be changed. This protects the account from unauthorized takeover.

Customer question: My old email address is no longer available. Can support change it? **Answer:** Support can guide the customer through account-recovery and verification procedures. The customer should be prepared to confirm appropriate account information without revealing passwords or security codes.

4. Account Verification and Two-Factor Authentication

Account verification helps confirm that the person accessing an account is authorized to use it. Two-factor authentication can provide an additional layer of protection by requiring a second verification step.

Customers should keep recovery information current and should not share authentication codes with another person. If a verification code arrives unexpectedly, the customer should treat the event as potentially suspicious and secure the account.

Customer question: Someone may be trying to access my account. What should I do? **Answer:** Change the password through the official account process, review account activity where available, secure authentication methods, and contact customer support if unauthorized access is suspected.

5. Locked Accounts and Recovery

An account can become temporarily inaccessible after repeated unsuccessful sign-in attempts or security checks. Customers should avoid repeatedly attempting passwords because additional attempts may prolong the recovery process.

Use the official recovery process first. If recovery does not work, contact customer support and explain that the account cannot be accessed. Support may request verification information appropriate to the account-recovery process.

Customer question: My account is locked after several failed attempts. **Answer:** Stop repeated login attempts, use the password-recovery process, and contact support if the account remains inaccessible.

6. Multiple Devices and Sessions

Customers may sign in on more than one trusted device. When using a shared or public computer, customers should sign out after completing their session.

If a customer no longer recognizes a device or session, the customer should secure the account and review available session-management options. Changing the password may invalidate existing access depending on the account security configuration.

Customer question: I used my account on another computer. What security step should I take? **Answer:** Sign out when finished and avoid saving credentials on a shared computer.

7. Notifications and Communication Preferences

Customers can manage available notification and communication preferences from their account. Preferences may include product information, service notifications, and support communications.

Important service or security communications may still be sent when necessary to protect the account or complete a support interaction. Customers should keep their contact information current.

8. Account Deletion and Data

Customers who no longer need an account can request account deletion through the available account-management process. Before deletion, customers should review any active orders or support cases that may require attention.

Deletion may affect access to account history and support information associated with the account. Customers should follow the deletion instructions presented during the request.

9. Common Account Problems and Escalation

Common issues include forgotten passwords, missing verification messages, outdated contact details, locked accounts, unexpected security notifications, and inability to complete account recovery.

When normal recovery steps do not resolve an issue, contact customer support during Monday through Friday, 9:00 AM–6:00 PM IST. Limited weekend support is available through email.

Support escalation should include a clear description of the problem, approximate time of occurrence, and relevant non-sensitive account information. Customers should never include passwords or authentication codes.

Customer Scenarios and Quick Answers

Scenario: A customer receives repeated password-reset messages they did not request. Recommended action: Do not use unexpected reset instructions, secure the account through the official process, and contact support if suspicious activity continues.

Scenario: A customer changes their phone but still has access to the account. Recommended action: Update the phone number through authenticated account settings and verify the new information.

Scenario: A customer cannot receive messages at the registered email address. Recommended action: Begin account recovery and be prepared for appropriate identity or account verification.

Scenario: A customer used a shared computer. Recommended action: Sign out and avoid saving credentials on the shared device.

Account Management FAQ

Can I use the same password on multiple services? No. Use a unique password for the Contoso Devices account.

Can support tell me my password? No. Support should not provide or request a customer's password.

Can I change my profile information? Yes, use the authenticated account-management process.

What if I see an unfamiliar sign-in? Secure the account and contact support if unauthorized activity is suspected.

Can I delete an account with an open support issue? Review the issue first because deletion can affect access to account history.

Detailed Customer Scenarios and Decision Examples

The following examples illustrate how the knowledge base should be applied to different customer wording. The examples intentionally use varied language so retrieval systems can connect related requests to the correct policy.

Recovery example

A customer cannot access an old email account. The appropriate response is to begin the account-recovery process and complete the available verification steps rather than bypassing account security.

Recommended support approach: identify the customer's intent, locate the applicable documented rule, state only what the knowledge base supports, and provide the next appropriate action. If eligibility cannot be established from the available information, request the relevant details or direct the customer to support review rather than inventing an exception.

Security example

A customer receives an unexpected sign-in notification. They should secure the account through official controls, change the password if appropriate, and contact support if unauthorized activity is suspected.

Recommended support approach: identify the customer's intent, locate the applicable documented rule, state only what the knowledge base supports, and provide the next appropriate action. If eligibility cannot be established from the available information, request the relevant details or direct the customer to support review rather than inventing an exception.

Profile example

A customer changes their phone number and still has account access. They should update the authenticated profile and verify the new contact information.

Recommended support approach: identify the customer's intent, locate the applicable documented rule, state only what the knowledge base supports, and provide the next appropriate action. If eligibility cannot be established from the available information, request the relevant details or direct the customer to support review rather than inventing an exception.

Deletion example

A customer wants to delete an account with an unresolved support case. They should review the case first because deletion can affect access to account history.

Recommended support approach: identify the customer's intent, locate the applicable documented rule, state only what the knowledge base supports, and provide the next appropriate action. If eligibility cannot be established from the available information, request the relevant details or direct the customer to support review rather than inventing an exception.

Shared-device example

A customer signs in on a public computer. They should sign out and avoid saving credentials or authentication information.

Recommended support approach: identify the customer's intent, locate the applicable documented rule, state only what the knowledge base supports, and provide the next appropriate action. If eligibility cannot be established from the available information, request the relevant details or direct the customer to support review rather than inventing an exception.

Verification example

A customer cannot complete account verification. They should use the official recovery route and provide only the information requested by the support process.

Recommended support approach: identify the customer's intent, locate the applicable documented rule, state only what the knowledge base supports, and provide the next appropriate action. If eligibility cannot be established from the available information, request the relevant details or direct the customer to support review rather than inventing an exception.

Knowledge Retrieval Reference

Customer questions may use different terms from the policy. For example, a customer may say that an item is broken, faulty, damaged, defective, or not working. The support process should distinguish the underlying condition rather than relying on a single keyword.

A return question should be evaluated against the return period, product condition, reason for return, and applicable exclusions. A warranty question should be evaluated against warranty duration, covered conditions, and exclusions.

A shipping question should be evaluated against order processing, carrier tracking, delivery status, address information, and shipment condition. A troubleshooting question should be evaluated against the specific symptom and the documented diagnostic procedure.

When the knowledge base does not contain sufficient information to answer a question, the system should not manufacture an answer. It should clearly state that the available customer-support knowledge base does not contain sufficient information.

Source citations should identify the document, page, relevance, and retrieved text needed to explain the answer. Internal prompts, credentials, environment variables, and unrelated system information should never be exposed through citations.

Support Interpretation Example 1

Example 1: A customer uses informal language to describe a account management knowledge base issue. The correct response should map the customer's description to the closest documented policy or procedure, avoid unsupported assumptions, and identify the relevant next step. If the available documentation is insufficient, the response should stop at the knowledge-base limitation instead of supplying unrelated general knowledge.

Support Interpretation Example 2

Example 2: A customer uses informal language to describe a account management knowledge base issue. The correct response should map the customer's description to the closest documented policy or procedure, avoid unsupported assumptions, and identify the relevant next step. If the available documentation is insufficient, the response should stop at the knowledge-base limitation instead of supplying unrelated general knowledge.

Support Interpretation Example 3

Example 3: A customer uses informal language to describe a account management knowledge base issue. The correct response should map the customer's description to the closest documented policy or procedure, avoid unsupported assumptions, and identify the relevant next step. If the available documentation is insufficient, the response should stop at the knowledge-base limitation instead of supplying unrelated general knowledge.

Support Interpretation Example 4

Example 4: A customer uses informal language to describe a account management knowledge base issue. The correct response should map the customer's description to the closest documented policy or procedure, avoid unsupported assumptions, and identify the relevant next step. If the available documentation is insufficient, the response should stop at the knowledge-base limitation instead of supplying unrelated general knowledge.

Support Interpretation Example 5

Example 5: A customer uses informal language to describe a account management knowledge base issue. The correct response should map the customer's description to the closest documented policy or procedure, avoid unsupported assumptions, and identify the relevant next step. If the available documentation is insufficient, the response should stop at the knowledge-base limitation instead of supplying unrelated general knowledge.

Support Interpretation Example 6

Example 6: A customer uses informal language to describe a account management knowledge base issue. The correct response should map the customer's description to the closest documented policy or procedure, avoid unsupported assumptions, and identify the relevant next step. If the available documentation is insufficient, the response should stop at the knowledge-base limitation instead of supplying unrelated general knowledge.